

HORIZON TECHNOLOGIES

Remote Work Policy

Document ID	POL-003
Version	1.0
Effective date	2026-01-01
Policy owner	Horizon Technologies Human Resources
Classification	Internal - Fictional Training Data

This is a fictional policy created for an educational AI project. It does not describe a real company and does not provide legal, tax, immigration, medical, or financial advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

Set eligibility, workspace, scheduling, performance, approval, and review requirements for routine remote and hybrid work arrangements.

Scope

This policy applies to Horizon Technologies employees seeking recurring work from an approved home workspace. Temporary work from another state or country is governed additionally by POL-004.

Authority and interpretation

This policy provides a consistent fictional source of truth for employees, managers, and the educational HR assistant. Automated guidance is preliminary. Authorized reviewers remain responsible for approvals, exceptions, official records, and specialist decisions. When applicable law, a customer obligation, a written employment term, or another controlling document differs, the matter must be escalated rather than resolved by assumption.

2. Definitions

Remote work

Work performed from an approved location other than a Horizon office.

Hybrid work

A recurring schedule combining office and remote days.

Primary work location

The city, state, and country recorded in the employee profile for employment administration.

Temporary location

A place used for a limited period that is not the approved primary work location.

Using defined terms

Defined terms should be interpreted consistently across retrieval, tool calls, traces, and final responses. If a user's wording could match more than one definition, the agent should ask a concise clarification question before reaching a conclusion.

3. Core Requirements

Rule 1

Remote-work eligibility depends on role duties, performance standing, information-security requirements, time-zone coverage, and an approved primary work location.

Rule 2

Employees in their first sixty days normally work according to the onboarding plan. A manager and HR may approve earlier remote work when training, accessibility, or business needs support it.

Rule 3

A remote arrangement does not change compensation, employment entity, tax location, or primary work location unless HR confirms the change in writing.

Rule 4

Employees must maintain a private, safe, and reliable workspace with dependable internet, appropriate ergonomics, and protection from unauthorized viewing or conversation.

4. Additional Requirements

Rule 5

Employees must be reachable during agreed working hours, attend required meetings, maintain calendar availability, and meet the same performance and conduct standards as office-based employees.

Rule 6

Company information may be accessed only through approved devices, accounts, networks, and security controls described in POL-005.

Rule 7

Routine domestic travel of five business days or fewer may be permitted by the manager when the location is not restricted and core hours remain covered. Longer or international work requires POL-004 review.

Rule 8

Managers review remote arrangements at least every six months and may propose changes based on documented role, performance, security, or operational needs.

Evidence standard

A conclusion must identify the employee facts and policy sections supporting it. Missing evidence should produce a limitation, clarification, or escalation, not an invented fact.

5. Request and Approval Process

Step 1

The employee identifies the requested arrangement, primary workspace, schedule, time zone, equipment, and expected duration.

Step 2

The manager reviews role suitability, team coverage, performance, and collaboration needs.

Step 3

IT or Security reviews elevated-access roles and nonstandard technical requirements.

Step 4

HR confirms the primary work location and records the approved arrangement.

Status communication

The requester should receive a clear status: approved, denied with a policy-based reason, pending clarification, or escalated for specialist review. A preliminary agent assessment is never a substitute for required written approval.

6. Exceptions and Escalation

Escalation 1

Disability, pregnancy, religious, and other accommodation requests must be referred to HR and evaluated separately from ordinary remote-work preference requests.

Escalation 2

International work, relocation, or work from an unapproved state requires POL-004 review before travel begins.

Escalation 3

Security incidents, unreliable connectivity, or material performance concerns may require temporary suspension while HR and the manager review facts.

Recorded exceptions

An exception is valid only when an authorized reviewer records its scope, conditions, and duration. A prior exception for another person or request does not create automatic permission.

7. Responsibilities and Related Policies

Employee responsibilities

Work only from approved locations. Protect confidential conversations and screens. Report changes to address or work location before they occur. Follow security, attendance, equipment, and conduct policies.

Manager and HR responsibilities

Apply eligibility factors consistently. Define schedules and outcomes clearly. Avoid treating an accommodation request as a routine preference. Document changes and coordinate with HR and Security.

Related policies

POL-004 Temporary Work Location Policy; POL-005 Information Security Policy; POL-007 Company Equipment Policy; POL-010 Employee Onboarding Policy

Multi-policy retrieval

Related policies should be retrieved together when a request spans more than one subject. Conflicting or incomplete evidence must be identified and escalated.

8. Examples, Records, and Revision History

Standard example

A software engineer in good standing requests two remote days each week from the home address already recorded in the HR profile. The manager may review collaboration and coverage before approval.

Clarification or escalation example

An employee plans to work from another country for six weeks. The routine remote-work policy alone is insufficient; the request requires employee lookup, multi-policy evidence, compliance review, and HR escalation under POL-004.

Records and privacy

Records must remain in approved systems and contain only information needed for the process. The assistant may retrieve evidence, summarize rules, check synthetic data, and create a mock action after confirmation. It may not make a legally binding decision or claim a mock action affected a real system.

Revision history

Version 1.0 - 2026-01-01 - Initial fictional policy.